

THE MAIN EVENT

India Win the World Cup

Nobody at Lord's on that historic day, whether British or West Indian, could grudge India that glorious moment when Kapil Dev lifted the glittering World Cup high into the air in triumph, while huge crowds below danced the *bhangra*. For once, the crisis had been silenced and never more effectively so. "Kapil's men turn world upside down" screamed the London *Times* headline while the report went on to term India as "cannon-fodder

turned cannon". The losing captain, Clive Lloyd gave full credit to Kapil. "He's been able to rally the entire team behind him," said Lloyd admiringly, adding: "He's

really done a marvellous job."

Tragically, Lloyd relinquished his captaincy one day before the final when he announced that he would no longer captain the side.

India Today, July 15, 1983

ALSO

- Menaka Gandhi and Indira Gandhi go their separate ways
- India's Bandit Queen, Phoolan Devi, surrenders
- Sunil Gavaskar surpasses Don Bradman's record of 29 Test centuries



THE FIRST BATCH OF IMPORTED CARS IN THE MARUTI FACTORY IN 1984

|1983 | MARUTI 800 IS LAUNCHED

Driving the India Story

The people's car allowed middle class Indians to dream bigger

"And it is my desire that this motor car will serve the ordinary people of India and they will have no complaint about it. I hope it will contribute in every aspect of the nation building." While delivering her speech to a packed auditorium at the launch of the Maruti 800, the late Prime Minister Indira Gandhi was speaking through tears. December 14, 1983 was clearly an emotional moment for Mrs Gandhi. Not only was it the birth anniversary of her son Sanjay Gandhi, but it also marked the fulfillment of his dream: the "people's car". It was a struggle, recalls R.C. Bhargava, the chairman of Maruti Suzuki India, especially since they had less than two years to look for an associate, get plant and machinery and develop the product. The toughest part was getting a suitable partner. After negotiations failed with Volkswagen and Diahatsu, Suzuki stepped into the picture, thanks to an article by INDIA TODAY. A director of Suzuki Motors was travelling to India, when he read a story about Maruti looking for a partner. On October 2, 1982, Maruti and Suzuki signed the dotted line and "the mad rush began." There were umpteen moments of panic. The factory building itself was dilapidated and the team had to deal with issues of the roof caving in and the factory floor getting flooded in the rains. More than that, it was the idea of manufacturing and selling 100,000 cars in a country which had only seen sales of 35,000-40,000 cars every year, for the last ten years, that was daunting. Moreover, at a pre-launch press meet in Kolkata, journalists wondered whether the car would make it through the monsoon puddles or not. In 1983, the car was launched Rs 52,500 (on road Delhi price). Delhi based Harpal Singh, an Air India official, was the first customer. He went on to become something of a celebrity later. And in 1984, when Bhargava visited Kolkata, the journalists told him that the only car to have made it to the airport was the Maruti 800. He and his car had been redeemed.

by Nandini Valsh

THE CAR WAS LAUNCHED, IN RED AND WHITE, FOR RS 52,500 WITH 120,000 BOOKINGS.

Top
10
Scores

Y2K A computer bug suggesting a theory that all computers would crash at the end of the 20th century.

Anthrax scare In 2001, letters with anthrax spores were mailed to several news media offices in the US.

Global Warming An increase in the Earth's temperature is the most debated topic in the last 30 years.

The Fear of 1984 Published in 1949, this dystopian novel concluded that life would intimate fiction.

Facebook and the CIA A theory links the networking site to CIA and the US defence Department.